

Sustainable Business Showcase Microgrant Proposal

Introduction:

Hello, we are a non-profit organization called UNSD Youth based in Vancouver aiming to raise awareness about the 17 United Nations Sustainable Development Goals. We are planning for an event in the spring and would love to take advantage of this amazing grant opportunity!

The Sustainable Business Showcase is designed to promote sustainability, support local businesses, and inspire the community to embrace environmentally conscious practices. This event will feature keynote speakers, workshops, performers on stage, and a market showcase and sale to engage and educate attendees.

The purpose of our project is to raise awareness of all the ways we can all integrate environmentally-friendly practices in our lives: purchasing products from sustainable businesses, upcycling clothing and things such as bottles and cans that would typically be thrown away, and learning from others who are like-minded and all hope to work towards a better, greener tomorrow. We want to promote sustainable businesses and foster an environmentally-driven community here in Greater Vancouver.

This event is planned for the beginning of June 2024 but is past the submission deadline for the project completion deadline of March 15th, 2024. We will still be hosting the Business Showcase event but will additionally do research and interview sustainable businesses in order to provide a physical brochure on **How to create a sustainable small business as a youth in Canada** by the deadline. Attendees of the event each receive a copy of the brochure to take home in case they want to refer back to the learning process.

The goal of this written guide is to inspire youth to create a sustainable small business of their own. This will help meet various market demands in the world while making a difference to sustainability on Earth focusing on the 17 UN SDGs combatting climate action.

Project Goals:

- Educate youths about sustainable businesses and how to create one
- Inspire youths to create their own sustainable small businesses
- Provide current small business owners an opportunity to reach a larger audience and interact with other small business owners
- Support local small businesses
- Meet various United Nations SDGs aligning with our organization's overall aim including:
 - Goal 4: Quality Education
 - Goal 8: Decent Work and Economic Growth
 - Goal 9: Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure
 - Goal 11: Sustainable Cities and Communities

- Goal 12: Responsible Consumption and Production
- Goal 13: Climate Action

Methods and Strategies:

1. Physical Written Brochure (done before March 15th)
 - a. Method: a written brochure that will be distributed at the event to guide youth on building their own sustainable business
 - b. Rationale: This will allow youth to hone in their skills and create a lasting effect of this event.
2. Event planning and Coordination
 - a. Method: Establish a dedicated event planning committee within the UNSD exec team to coordinate all aspects of the showcase
 - b. Rationale: Centralized coordination ensures seamless execution, from securing speakers and small businesses to managing the market sale
3. Speaker and Workshops
 - a. Method: Identify and invite successful entrepreneurs in the sustainability sector to educate youth
 - b. Rationale: Engaging speakers and workshops provide valuable insights, educating youth on sustainable practices and business opportunities
4. Youth Engagement:
 - a. Method: Develop targeted programs, workshops, and interactive activities such as business fairs in the afternoon.
 - b. Rationale: Focusing on youth education and involvement aligns with the goal of inspiring the next generation to embrace sustainability and entrepreneurship.
5. Business Fair:
 - a. Method: Curate a diverse selection of sustainable businesses to participate in the market sale.
 - b. Rationale: Providing a platform for small businesses to showcase and sell their sustainable products directly supports local enterprises and encourages sustainable consumer choices. This initiative serves as an inspirational catalyst for the next generation, encouraging entrepreneurial aspirations and the pursuit of sustainable business ventures.
6. Network Opportunities:
 - a. Method: Designate networking areas for attendees to interact with each other and small business owners.
 - b. Rationale: fostering connections between businesses and the community nurtures a collaborative atmosphere, offering a supportive platform for youth to establish valuable networks.
7. Marketing Strategy

- a. Method: Via UNSD Youth's Tiktok and Instagram account, school newspaper and possible flyers in community centers
 - b. Rationale: The popularity and widespread use of TikTok and Instagram among high school students ensure direct access to the target demographic and facilitate effective communication and engagement. Employing school newspapers taps into trusted and established communication channels within the education community. It helps convey information in a format familiar to students and aligns with the traditional means of disseminating news and updates within the school environment. Distributing flyers serves as a tangible, offline method to reach not only students but also parents. This approach maximizes visibility within the local community, fostering a comprehensive and inclusive outreach strategy.
8. Feedback Mechanism:
- a. Method: Implement a feedback system to gather input from attendees, businesses and speakers.
 - b. Rationale: Continuous feedback helps evaluate the success of the event and provides insights for future improvements.
9. Partnerships and Sponsorships:
- a. Method: Seek partnerships with local organizations, governmental bodies, and environmentally conscious businesses.
 - b. Rationale: Partnerships enhance credibility, expand resources, and create a broader impact.

Activities and Tasks:

Pre-Event Preparations:

1. Securing Keynote Speakers:
 - Activity: Drafting interest-check emails to businesses.
 - Responsible: UNSD Outreach Manager.
2. Securing Small Businesses for the Fair:
 - Activity: Drafting outreach emails to small businesses.
 - Responsible: UNSD Outreach Manager.
3. Securing Venue:
 - Activity: Venue planning discussions.
 - Responsible: UNSD Logistic Team, Finance Manager, President, and Vice President.
4. Hiring Volunteers:

- Activity: Sending volunteer list emails and Instagram posts.
- Responsible: UNSD Volunteer Coordinator.

5. Writing physical brochure:

- Activity: writing out the steps and tips on how to be successful with small business
- Responsible: UNSD Exec team member

Morning Session: Small Business Workshop

10:00-10:30 AM: Registration and Welcome

Activity: Set up registration booths, distribute materials, and welcome participants.

- Responsible: UNSD Exec Team & Volunteers
- Timeframe: 10:00-10:30 AM.

10:30-11:00 AM: Keynote speaker by a successful sustainable business owner and why you should support/become one

- Activity: Conduct a workshop with experienced business leaders providing valuable insights for participants on the importance of supporting sustainable business
- Responsible: UNSD Exec team alongside MC
- Timeframe: 10:30-11:00 AM.

11:00-11:10 AM: Short Break

- Activity: Provide Snacks and beverages. An opportunity for participants to socialize
- Responsible: Workshop facilitators.
- Timeframe: 11:10 AM-12:00 PM.

11:10-12:00 AM: How to Make a Small Business Workshop

- Activity: Conduct workshops with experienced business leaders providing valuable insights for participants. There will be time for participants to ask questions and also
- Responsible: UNSD Exec team alongside MC
- Timeframe: 10:30-11:00 AM.

12:00-1:15 PM: Lunch and Networking

- Activity: Provide lunch and encourage networking among participants and established businesses.
- Responsible: Catering team and UNSD Exec team
- Timeframe: 12:00-1:15 PM.

Afternoon Session: Small Business Market/Fair

1:15-1:30 PM: Set-Up for Small Business Market/Fair

- Activity: Allow student-led businesses to set up their booths and local businesses to set up their booth
- Responsible: Participating businesses and UNSD volunteer members
- Timeframe: 1:15-1:30 PM.

1:30-4:00 PM: Small Business Market/Fair

- Activity: Participants explore booths, interact with businesses, and make purchases.
- Responsible: Participating businesses, event organizers, and volunteers.
- Timeframe: 1:30-4:00 PM.

4:00 PM: Closing and Thank You

- Activity: Conclude the event, express gratitude, take a group photo
- Responsible: UNSD Exec Team and MC.
- Timeframe: 4:00 PM.

Notes:

- There will be a media team to record the event for promotion purposes
- Before this event, we will be running through a test trial

Implementation Plan:

1. After finalizing the plan:
2. Look for venue possibilities and reach out to them
3. Secure partnerships, sponsorships, etc.
4. Market this event to local small business owners
5. Email successful big sustainable businesses about speaking
6. Email experts about hosting a workshop on building sustainable businesses
7. Secure venue
8. Confirm speakers, workshops, and businesses
9. Market this event to the public through social media, schools, posters, organizations, etc.
10. Buy/rent all needed materials such as food, tables, mics, etc.

There are many risks such as not finding the best venue, partnerships, owners, speakers, etc. but through hard work and dedication throughout the year, this event is likely possible and something that we need in our community.

Resource Allocation:

- We will try and find our speakers for free
- We will need money to rent the venue (covered by grant money)- the amount depends on the venue and time- this should be secured as soon the speakers and participating businesses are confirmed

- Food and drinks- we'd like for lunch to be covered by the grant money
- We will need mics, projectors, tables, etc. but those could be borrowed or rented
- We should get a banner and marketing materials as this is a big year-end event for us, covered by grant money, use 1-2 months before the event

Monitoring and Evaluation:

1. Attendance and Participation: We will keep track of the number of attendees and their active engagement during the event. This can be done through sign-in sheets, registration data, and surveys to measure the event's reach and impact.
2. Social Media Metrics: Monitor the performance of your event-related social media posts. Look at the number of likes, shares, comments, and overall engagement. We will keep an eye on specific hashtags or mentions related to your event.
3. Feedback Surveys: Create post-event surveys to gather feedback from attendees. Ask about their satisfaction levels, key takeaways, and suggestions for improvement. Analyze the responses to understand the event's effectiveness.
4. Partnerships and Collaborations: Evaluate the number and quality of partnerships formed with sustainable businesses during the event. Measure the extent to which these collaborations align with the event's goals.
5. Behavior Change: Monitor any changes in attendees' behavior and awareness regarding sustainable consumption. This can be done through follow-up surveys or tracking their engagement with sustainable businesses after the event.

We will generate progress reports at regular intervals, such as monthly or quarterly, throughout the year to assess the project's progress and success. These reports will include key metrics, insights, and recommendations for any necessary adjustments to achieve the project goals.

Project Timeline:

NOVEMBER:

- ☐ November 19 - Finish Proposal for "Sustainable Business Showcase"
- ☐ November 20 - Research all sustainable businesses in Greater Vancouver
- ☐ November 30 - Complete research with list of potential guest speakers and businesses to attend the showcase

DECEMBER:

- ☐ December 1 - Draft emails that will be sent to these businesses for interest check
- ☐ December 15 - Send all emails to selected sustainable businesses, speakers, performers, and workshop operators.
- ☐ December 15 to 30 - Begin discussing venue plans and meet with Vancouver / Richmond to discuss the operation of this event.

JANUARY:

- ☐ January 15 - Finalize location of the event and begin planning bookings and specific venues.
- ☐ January 23 - Start round 2 of researching sustainable businesses in the Greater Vancouver Area as backup in case the first batch does not reach the expected amount of interest.
- ☐ January 30 - Ideally by now, all guest speakers, businesses, and performers have replied to the interest check email.

FEBRUARY:

- ☐ February 1 - Based on reply rates as well as positive or negative responses from those interest emails, we can gauge whether or not we need to reach out to more businesses, or if we can begin finalizing the guest list.
 - ☐ If the responses are negative, we will continue research and email / meet with more businesses.
 - ☐ If the responses are positive, we will begin compiling the list of honoured guests (the businesses, speakers, and performers), estimate the total number of attendees, choose an venue of appropriate size and capacity.
- ☐ February 20 - The physical written brochure on “How to Engage in Sustainable Consumption, and How to Start and Manage a Sustainable Business?” will be completed. This is a brochure that will be handed to all of the attendees of the event.
- ☐ February 1 to 29 - All of February will be centered on networking, reaching out to businesses and speakers, booking venues, solidifying plans, and further developing logistics with the city that the event will be hosted in.

MARCH:

- ☐ March 1 to 5 - Venue should be booked and confirmed. A map of what the event will look like must be established.
- ☐ March 7 to 14 - List of all businesses, speakers, and performers attending should be roughly finalized. The emails sent in batch 2 should all have replies by now. We will act according to those emails as to whether or not recruitment of more businesses is necessary.
- ☐ March 15 to 23 - **ALL** logistics should be **FINALIZED AND COMPLETE**.

- ☐ We will meet with the event coordinators of the city that the event is held in to finalize plans for the event and gain approval from the city.
- ☐ March 22 - WORLD WATER DAY
- ☐ March 23 - WORLD METEOROLOGICAL DAY
- ☐ March 24 to 31 - Marketing and promotions begin. During this week, all posters, social media posts, and announcements should be completed and ready to post. We will ask all the businesses to provide a list of products or services they may be offering so that we can include these in our promotional posts.
- ☐ March 30 - INTERNATIONAL DAY OF ZERO WASTE

APRIL:

- ☐ April 2 to 12 - Begin promoting the event through posting on social media, hanging posters in community centers, spreading the news in schools, and asking for marketing support from the city.
- ☐ April 15-30 - During this time, **ALL PLANS MUST BE COMPLETE, FINALIZED, AND APPROVED.** By the end of April, the event must be completely mapped out from start to finish. We should also have the finalized list of guest speakers, businesses, performers, and workshops. In April, we will send all these honoured guests the finalized schedule of the event as well as a labelled map of the venue of where their specific station will be.
- ☐ April 22 - **EARTH DAY** (woohoo!)

MAY:

- ☐ May 1 to 30 - In this month, we must market and promote our event as extensively as possible. On May 1, we will post a Google Form with a sign-up sheet. This will not be mandatory for attendees to complete, we just want to do this to roughly estimate numbers and gauge our reach with this event.
- ☐ May 15 - A reminder email will be sent to all of the honoured guests that the event will be happening June 2. With this email, there will be an attached schedule with exact times of when the first call time is, when set up will happen, when attendees will arrive, when each workshop will be happening, when each speaker will be presenting, when attendees will leave, and when clean-up will happen. Alongside the detailed schedule, we will send them a map of the venue again. We will send all of the businesses a photo and publication waiver regarding whether or not we are allowed to include them in videos and photographs.
- ☐ We will use the same consent waivers for all of the attendees.
- ☐ May 15 to 25 - In this time, we will do final touches of the event and discuss any final suggestions with the managers and staff from the venue.
- ☐ We will also use this time to make

- ☐ May 25 - We will run a mock of the event as if it were the real event. The businesses will be free to attend; however, it is only suggested that speakers and performers to come in order to test the acoustics of the venue and to get comfortable with this space.
 - ☐ According to how this mock goes, we might need to fix some operational issues and edit our plans. We will use this last week before the event to apply the feedback received from the test run of the event to smooth out any bumps in our schedule or planning.
 - ☐ We will inform the honoured guests with any and all changes that we make.

JUNE:

- ☐ June 2 - **THE DAY OF THE EVENT!**
- ☐ June 3 - Send “thank you” emails to all the businesses, speakers, performers, event coordinators, and attendees who came to this event and made our dream possible! This email will also be an opportunity for those involved with this event to provide feedback to us for next time.
 - ☐ In this email, there will be a satisfaction survey for honoured guests and attendees to fill in, which will let us know of how well (or not well) the event was executed; it will be a reflection of the quality of our work and the effects of our decisions over the past year of planning.

Conclusion:

On behalf of the UNSD Youth Team, we are grateful for this spectacular opportunity the GLOCAL Foundation of Canada offers. The grant will be an important factor in the success of our Sustainable Business Showcase event. We hope to inspire youth to make a difference in their community and showcase the small businesses fellow peers have already created. This event also hopes to raise awareness in different ways to integrate environmentally friendly practices into everyone's lives. And support current small business owners by providing an opportunity to reach a larger audience and network with other small business owners. Together, this event will motivate individuals to work towards a better and greener tomorrow while making a difference to the Earth focusing on the 17 UN SDGs combatting climate action.